CHAPTER 12

Minitest

Some people like the classics.

Some people don't like RSpec's syntax or its metaprogramming.

Some people use Minitest.

Minitest is the standard testing framework in the Ruby 2.0 Standard Library. It is also the default test framework for Rails. Compared to RSpec, Minitest is smaller, simpler, and less flexible. Minitest is also the testing suite used by the Rails team to test Rails itself. Minitest proponents say that a test suite is a terrible place to be dependent on metaprogramming and magic, and Minitest is easier to understand. RSpec proponents say that Minitest is not "expressive" and that Minitest tests are harder to understand.

It is *much more important* that you write tests than that you use a specific test framework. The overwhelming majority of the differences between RSpec and Minitest come down to style and taste, not functionality. To prove it, I offer the fact that an earlier version of this very book was centered on Minitest, and I changed it to a version centered on RSpec with basically no change to the underlying features or advice.

Prescription 28 The decision to write tests is much more important than the testing tool you choose to write them.

Minitest's design is based on a structure that was created by Kent Beck for the SUnit framework in Smalltalk and popularized by Beck and Erich Gamma in JUnit for Java. In Ruby this design was originally implemented in the Test::Unit framework, which Minitest supplanted. Minitest is considered cleaner and easier to extend than RSpec. It uses traditional testing terms like "test"